THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 — ENGLISH FULL SYLLABUS PAPER SET 01

Reading · Writing & Grammar · Literature (First Flight, Poetry, Footprints Without Feet) | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 3 Hours 15 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A (Reading, 20 marks): Q. 1–2, passages with 10 sub-questions each (1 mark each).
3. Section B (Writing, 12 marks): Q. 3 Notice (3), Q. 4 Letter (5), Q. 5 Analytical paragraph (4).
4. Section C (Grammar, 8 marks): Q. 6–13 (1 mark each).
5. Section D–G (Literature, 40 marks): Q. 14–21 objective (1 mark each), Q. 22–24 extract-based (4 marks each), Q. 25–28 short answer (2 marks each), Q. 29–32 long answer (3 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 3, 4, 5 and Q. 29 to 32.
7. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading: 20 Marks)

20 Marks

Read the passages and answer the questions that follow.

1. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Every generation believes that it has invented tiredness, but the truth is that ours is the first to carry a library, a cinema and a post office in its pocket. The mobile phone has made information cheap and quick, and for that we should be grateful. Yet something precious has quietly slipped away: the ability to stay with one thing for a long time.

Reading a book once meant surrendering an afternoon to a single voice. The reader sat still, followed a long argument or a long story, and was changed a little by the end. Today we skim. We read the headline and the first line, we jump to the comments, and we move on before the idea has had time to settle. Researchers who study attention say that the mind behaves like a muscle: it grows strong when it is made to hold a weight for a while, and it grows weak when it is allowed to drop it every few seconds.

This does not mean that screens are enemies. A student who uses a dictionary application to find the meaning of a difficult word is saving time that can be used for thinking. A village girl who watches a video to learn how to repair a pump is gaining a skill that her school could not offer. The trouble begins when the tool starts to decide how we spend our hours. An application that is designed to keep us scrolling is not our servant; it is a very patient salesman.

The remedy is not dramatic. A person who sets aside thirty minutes each day to read something printed, with the phone in another room, will soon find that the restlessness lessens. Libraries still have quiet corners, and a good book has no notifications. The first ten days are the hardest, as with any exercise, but the reward is a mind that can follow a thought to its end.

(i) According to the writer, our generation is special because it: 1

(a) carries a library, cinema and post office in its pocket **(b)** dislikes information

(c) invented tiredness **(d)** has stopped reading altogether

(ii) 'Surrendering an afternoon to a single voice' means: 1

(a) losing an afternoon in sleep **(b)** listening to many speakers

(c) giving one's full time to one writer's book **(d)** arguing with someone

(iii) Researchers compare the mind to a muscle because it: 1

(a) is always active **(b)** gets tired quickly

(c) cannot be trained **(d)** grows strong when it holds a weight for some time

(iv) Which example shows a good use of the phone? 1

(a) A girl learning to repair a pump from a video **(b)** Playing games in class

(c) Reading only headlines **(d)** Scrolling for hours at night

(v) The writer calls an application designed to keep us scrolling: 1

(a) a library **(b)** a teacher

(c) a very patient salesman **(d)** a faithful servant

(vi) What has the mobile phone made cheap and quick? 1

(vii) How does the habit of reading today differ from that of the past? 1

(viii) What remedy does the writer suggest? 1

(ix) Find a word from the passage which means 'a medicine or solution'. 1

(x) Find a word from the passage which is the opposite of 'strong'. 1

2. *Read the following case and the table, and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The Reading Club of a school conducted a survey among 200 students of Classes 9 and 10 to find how many minutes a day they spent on different activities.

Activity	Average minutes per day
Screen entertainment	110
Homework and tuition	75
Outdoor play	55
Reading books for pleasure	20

(i) Which activity took the most time per day? 1

(a) Screen entertainment **(b)** Homework

(c) Reading books **(d)** Playing outdoors

(ii) How many minutes a day do students spend reading books for pleasure? 1

(a) 95 **(b)** 45 **(c)** 20 **(d)** 60

(iii) Time spent outdoors is how much less than time spent on homework? 1

(a) 35 minutes **(b)** 20 minutes **(c)** 10 minutes **(d)** 55 minutes

(iv) What is the total time spent daily on homework and reading books? 1

(v) How many students were surveyed? 1

(vi) How many minutes more is spent on screen entertainment than on outdoor play? 1

(vii) What does the survey suggest about the students' reading habit? 1

(viii) Suggest one step the club can take to encourage reading. 1

(ix) Find a word in the first sentence which means 'a study of opinions or habits'. 1

(x) Which group of students was surveyed — boys, girls or both? 1

SECTION — B (Writing Skills: 12 Marks) — 12 Marks

Internal choice is given in each question.

3. Your school is going to conduct a Career Counselling Session. Write a notice in not more than 50 words. You are the school Counsellor. 3

OR

The school canteen will remain closed for repairs. Write a notice in not more than 50 words. You are the Vice Principal. 3

4. You are Vimal/Vimla of 3, Station Road, Kota. Write a letter to the Editor of a newspaper, in about 120 words, on the increasing noise pollution in your city. 5

OR

You are Gaurav/Gauri. Write a letter to your cousin, in about 120 words, thanking him/her for a gift sent on your birthday. 5

5. Write a paragraph in about 100 words on 'The Value of Punctuality'. 4

OR

Write a paragraph in about 100 words on 'The Importance of a Balanced Diet'. 4

SECTION — C (Grammar: 8 Marks) — 8 Marks

Attempt all the questions.

6. Fill in the blank with the correct form: He _____ (not/come) yesterday. 1

7. Choose the correct modal: Children _____ not play with fire. (should / can / may be) 1

8. Fill in the blank with the right article: He is _____ European. 1

9. Rewrite in reported speech: She said, "I have finished my work." 1

10. Change into passive voice: Someone has stolen my bag. 1

11. Join using 'who': The man is my uncle. He is standing at the gate. 1

12. Find and correct the error: He is one of the best player in the team. 1

13. Rearrange to form a meaningful sentence: taught / English / Mr Mehta / us / last year 1

SECTION — D (Literature: Objective Type) — 8 Marks

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

14. Who was sworn in as the first deputy president? 1

(a) F. W. de Klerk **(b)** Walter Sisulu **(c)** Thabo Mbeki **(d)** Oliver Tambo

15. The parents tried to make the seagull fly by: 1

(a) carrying him
(b) ignoring him completely always
(c) pushing him off the ledge
(d) scolding and threatening to let him starve

16. 'Paper has more patience than people' means that: 1

(a) people are impatient writers
(b) paper is better than books
(c) paper listens without judging or getting tired
(d) paper never tears

17. Fire in the poem stands for: 1

(a) desire (and passion/greed) **(b)** knowledge
(c) peace **(d)** wealth

18. The tiger's 'vivid stripes' suggest: 1

(a) dullness **(b)** age
(c) bright, bold colouring **(d)** weakness

19. The thief gave his name as: 1

(a) Anil **(b)** Ramu **(c)** Hari Singh **(d)** Raju

20. Fowler was a: 1

(a) young writer **(b)** policeman **(c)** spy **(d)** waiter

21. Horace Danby loved collecting: 1

(a) paintings **(b)** stamps
(c) coins **(d)** rare, expensive books

SECTION — E (Literature: Extract-based Questions) — 12 Marks

Read the extracts and answer the questions that follow.

22. *Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow.* 4

> Anne's class was nervous about the meeting in which the teachers would decide who would move up. Half the class was making bets. Anne was worried only about maths. She had nine teachers, seven men and two women, and she got along well with all. Mr Keesing, who taught maths, had been annoyed with her for a long time because she talked so much.

MASTERMIND

(i) Why was the class nervous? 1

(ii) What were half the class doing? 1

(iii) In which subject was Anne unsure? 1

(iv) Why was Mr Keesing annoyed with her? 1

23. *Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow.* 4

> The poem begins with a question about what the boy is to do after losing his ball. The poet saw it bounce merrily down the street and into the water. People may say there are other balls, but the boy is gripped by deep grief and stands rigid, staring into the harbour.

(i) What happened to the ball? 1

(ii) What do people say to console the boy? 1

(iii) How does the boy react? 1

(iv) Find a word that means 'stiff'. 1

24. *Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow.* 4

> Fowler followed Ausable down a musty corridor in a gloomy French hotel. The room was small, on the sixth floor, and not the setting for romantic adventure. Ausable was fat, wheezy and had an American accent, and Fowler felt let down. He had expected mysterious figures and the crack of pistols, not a quiet evening at a music hall.

(i) Where was Ausable's room? 1

(ii) Why did Fowler feel let down? 1

(iii) What had Fowler expected? 1

(iv) Find a word that means 'smelling of damp'. 1

SECTION — F (Literature: Short Answer Type) — 8 Marks

Answer in about 30–40 words each.

25. How did Maxwell obtain the otter? 2

26. Why did people say that Kisa Gotami had lost her senses? 2

27. Why does the poet not mention the trees' departure in her letters? 2

28. Why did Griffin become a homeless wanderer? 2

SECTION — G (Literature: Long Answer Type) — 12 Marks

Answer in about 80–100 words each.

29. Why does Mandela say that 'a man's goodness is a flame that can be hidden but never extinguished'? Give an example. 3

OR

Describe Valli's character with examples. 3

30. Is the title 'A Question of Trust' appropriate? 3

OR

Describe the wedding scene in 'Bholi'. 3

31. Describe the character of Lomov. 3

OR

Describe the role of Noodle in the play. 3

32. How does Frost use symbols in the poem? 3

OR

How does the poet use contrast in the poem? 3

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 80 Marks